RISHIRAJ UPADHYAY

Senior Software Engineer | Technical Lead

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer and Technical Lead with 11+ years of experience designing, developing, optimizing, and delivering scalable web applications, developer platforms, documentation experiences, and digital products. Hands-on expertise in JavaScript, React.js, Next.js, Gatsby.js, Node.js, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, Tailwind CSS, REST APIs, Contentstack headless CMS, responsive web development, performance optimization, SEO, accessibility, Git, CI/CD, debugging, refactoring, and production releases. Experienced in technical ownership, cross-functional delivery, mentoring, and AI-assisted engineering workflows using Claude and ChatGPT.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: JavaScript, React.js, Next.js, Gatsby.js, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, Tailwind CSS, jQuery, Bootstrap, Responsive Web Design

Backend and APIs: Node.js, REST APIs, API Integration

Headless CMS: Contentstack

Engineering: Git, CI/CD, Testing, Debugging, Refactoring, Performance Optimization, Production Readiness

Quality and Web: SEO, Accessibility, Cross-Browser Compatibility, Developer Experience

Leadership: Technical Leadership, Technical Ownership, Solution Planning, Technical Design, Code Review, Root Cause Analysis, Mentoring

AI ENGINEERING

- Used Claude and ChatGPT for codebase analysis, debugging, refactoring, test generation, technical research, documentation, implementation support, and workflow automation.
- Decomposed complex requirements into actionable tasks, evaluated implementation approaches, analyzed dependencies, and accelerated delivery while retaining technical review and engineering ownership.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Contentstack | Senior Software Engineer II, Technical Lead / Team Lead | 09/2015 - 08/2026

- Owned technical initiatives end to end, including solution planning, implementation, testing, production deployment, release management, troubleshooting, and continuous improvement.
- Led frontend and web engineering with React.js, Next.js, Gatsby.js, Node.js, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, and Tailwind CSS, emphasizing maintainability, performance, SEO, accessibility, and responsive design.
- Partnered with Product, Design, Marketing, and Engineering teams to solve complex technical problems, manage dependencies, and deliver projects.
- Contributed to CI/CD, production readiness, debugging, refactoring, technical documentation, release processes, and post-release improvements.

Selected Projects

Project Polaris

- Owned solution planning, implementation, performance optimization, production readiness, and continuous technical improvements.
- Contributed to approximately 30% growth in site traffic through performance, SEO, visibility, and user-experience improvements.
- Optimized frontend performance to nearly 90/100 by analyzing and resolving bottlenecks through optimization, refactoring, and debugging.
- Implemented a dark/light theme switcher with Tailwind CSS and Sass; used Claude and ChatGPT for technical analysis, research, testing, refactoring, and implementation.

Homepage Takeover Animation Project

- Owned an interactive, animation-driven homepage experience designed to showcase platform capabilities to prospective customers.
- Delivered an experience visitors used to evaluate the CMS platform, increasing customer reach and engagement.
- Contributed to nearly 40% growth in site traffic and improved visitor-to-customer conversion.

Contentstack Docs and API Docs

- Owned documentation experiences across development, optimization, production releases, troubleshooting, and continuous improvements.
- Improved performance and usability, focusing on page speed, SEO, accessibility, responsive design, and developer experience.
- Built and optimized documentation experiences using React.js, Gatsby.js, Next.js, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, and Sass.

ASK AI - Contentstack

- Contributed to frontend development and integration of ASK AI within Contentstack, including UI and API integration.
- Enabled users to get documentation-related answers through natural-language queries, improving developer experience and content discovery.
- Focused on performance, accessibility, and responsive design; helped reduce documentation search effort and support product adoption.

Kodework | UI Developer | 02/2015 - 09/2015

- Developed responsive website interfaces using HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery, and Bootstrap.
- Translated design concepts into production-ready responsive interfaces, supported brand development and UI implementation, and developed and customized WordPress websites.
- Built multiple client websites from scratch in WordPress, including the It's Goa website.
- Applied performance, SEO, and accessibility practices to improve page experience and help search engines and users access site content.
- Customized WordPress page layouts and site content to align with client requirements and visual designs.

Datamatics Global Services Limited | Web Designer | 10/2014 - 02/2015

- Developed website interfaces using HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery, and Bootstrap.
- Converted design requirements into responsive, browser-compatible web interfaces and supported brand development.
- Maintained the VFS Global website, resolving UI and functionality issues across its international web presence.
- Addressed site performance issues to support a faster, more reliable user experience.
- Investigated reported UI and functionality problems, implemented fixes, and checked the affected pages.

Kush Infosystem Private Limited | Web Developer | 01/2013 - 10/2014

- Developed websites using HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap, and WordPress.
- Built responsive web interfaces from business and design requirements and supported end-to-end website delivery.
- Translated client-provided PSD designs into working website interfaces and deployed completed sites to client hosting servers.
- Considered performance and SEO during implementation to support efficient page delivery and discoverability.
- Handled the delivery path from client design handoff through implementation and deployment to client hosting.

Thakur Polytechnic | Lecturer | 08/2011 - 01/2013

- Delivered technical instruction in Microprocessors, Digital Techniques, HTML, Multimedia and Animation Techniques, and Management.
- Prepared technical lectures and practical learning sessions covering computer and web technology fundamentals.
- Connected classroom concepts with practical exercises to help students apply technical fundamentals.

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Information Technology | RTM Nagpur University | 2008 - 2011
- Diploma, Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering | Maharashtra State Board of Technical Education (MSBTE) | 2005 - 2008
- Secondary School Certificate (SSC) | Mumbai | 2005

CERTIFICATIONS AND AWARDS

- Certification: Scrum Fundamentals Certified (SFC).
- Above and Beyond Award, Contentstack (twice): Recognized for animation-rich web experiences and contributions to CCON campaign websites.
- Best Developer, Kush Infosystems Pvt. Ltd.: Recognized for technical contribution and development expertise.
- Mentor, Smart India Hackathon 2018: Mentored an IT project at the event organized under MHRD.
- Jury Member: National Level Technical Paper Presentation at Thakur Polytechnic.
- Jury Member: National Level Project Competition sponsored by MSBTE at Thakur Polytechnic.
- Final Year Project: Developed a Face Recognition System using MATLAB 7.0.
- Technical Paper Presentation: Recognized for participation at MSBTE, Datta Meghe Polytechnic, Nagpur, and Pandav Engineering College.
- SCADA / PLC Course: Completed training in industrial automation and control systems.
- Winner: General Knowledge Competition (74%).

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Nationality: Indian

Visa Status: Available upon request

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English (Professional Working), Hindi (Full Professional), Marathi (Limited Working)